

Big circle : The sailor's wife

Comp. : Trad. Scotland

Disc. : Ian Fraser

Notes : "Big circle" is the original name given by the choreographers to the mixer dance 99% of Balfolkers wrongly name as "Circassian circle" which is in fact a dance from the British isles. To confuse matters even further, the Circassians are a Caucasian ethnic group! Oy! This is a pre-18th century tune with a baroque-like melody. It's great fun to play in jams or on stage. It's safe to say that the sailor's wife was a good dancer knowing full well the meaning of the Irish-gaelic word Craic!!

♩ = 120

The musical score is written in 6/8 time with a key signature of one flat (Bb). It consists of two systems of staves, each with a treble clef and a repeat sign at the beginning.

System 1 (Measures 1-5):

- Measure 1: Chord **A** (boxed), Dm
- Measure 2: Dm
- Measure 3: Am
- Measure 4: Dm
- Measure 5: Dm

System 2 (Measures 6-10):

- Measure 6: Chord **A**
- Measure 7: Chord **1.** Dm
- Measure 8: Chord **2.** Dm
- Measure 9: Chord **B** (boxed), F
- Measure 10: F

System 3 (Measures 11-15):

- Measure 11: Chord **G**
- Measure 12: Chord **C**
- Measure 13: Chord **A**
- Measure 14: Chord **Dm**
- Measure 15: Chord **C**

System 4 (Measures 16-20):

- Measure 16: Chord **Dm**
- Measure 17: Chord **1.**
- Measure 18: Chord **2.** Dm
- Measure 19: Chord **1.**
- Measure 20: Chord **2.** Dm